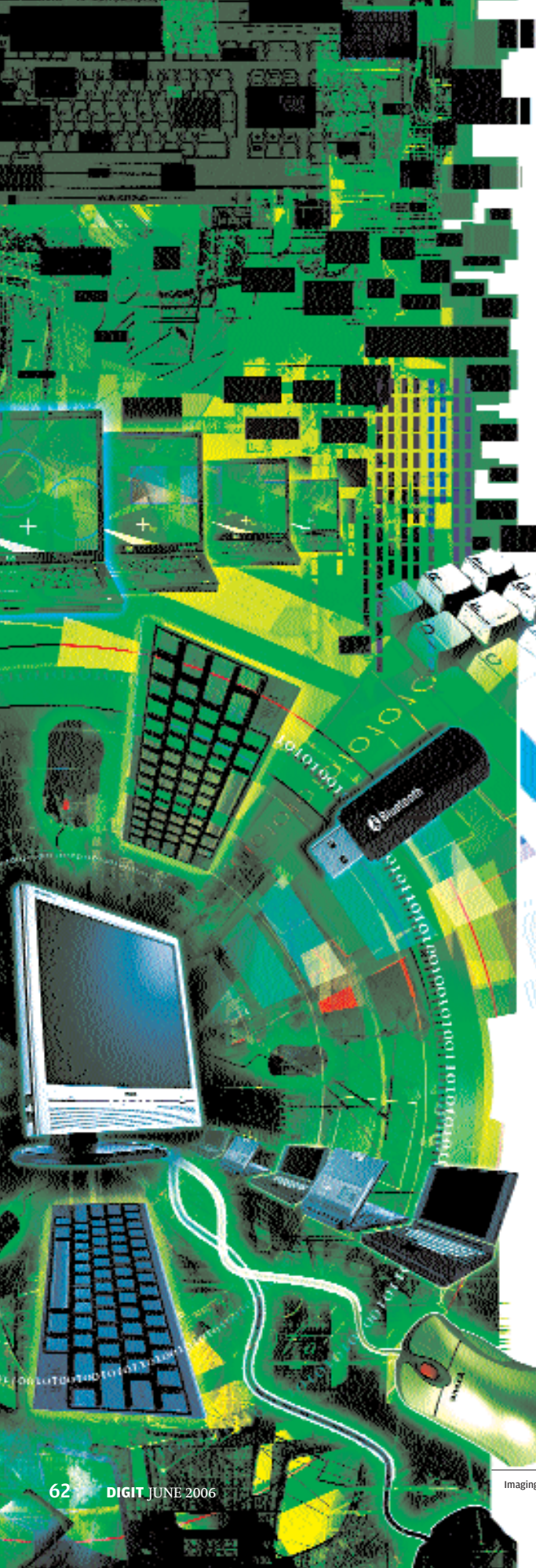




Gadgetise!

Goodies that make your personal computing experience more... personal

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The willing slave, the workhorse, the friend(?); we all have a strange and undefined relationship with our boxes. Most of all, we're all tired of their dry, boring classic forms. 'Tis the age of cool, and all PCs have started queuing up for a makeover more suited to these crazy times of indulgence.

Listen And Obey

We've been tied to the same old keyboard and mouse for nearly two decades—and rightly so. There have been several alternative input devices for the PC—from strange claws to incomprehensible foot-pedals, but in the end, we all return to the warm fuzzy safety of our keyboards. QWERTY is our religion and WASD its gaming sect!

Create your own keyboard

True, we love our keyboards, but that still doesn't mean we should remain content with the layout. The DX1 input system lets you create your own personalised keyboard layout for that perfect key-punching experience. What starts out as a blank pad becomes your own personalised keyboard as you attach keys on it. Hardcore gamer or just plain keyboard warrior, this one's for you—just slap on a key where you want it, assign a combination of keys or a macro and be done with it. It even lets you add new keys in the heat of a game, so you can add new action as soon as you discover you need it!

URL: www.ergodex.com

The Hand—the next input device?

Ever wanted to grab a window and throw it into a corner à la *Minority Report*? Researchers are working on a device that will enable you to do just that: the DataGlove, originally developed by VPL research. Sensors in the glove detect your hand

movements, completely immersing you into the world of file and window handling.

For more information on the original DataGlove and similar devices, head to the site below. It's not clear where one can be bought, but prices of such devices are reportedly falling rapidly.

URL: www.cse.unsw.edu.au/~waleed/thesis/node33.html

Tagalong

Falling laptop prices have almost made it a realistic substitute for the desktop PC, especially with most of them getting faster than your entry-level machine. To the average geek, a computer is only about how much juice it has, and to the geek on the go, it's about how much juice you can carry around with you.

The Dell Inspiron XPS M1710

This runs on an Intel Core Duo processor, has 2 GB of system RAM, a 100 GB SATA hard disk, a killer GeForce Go 7900 GTX with 512 MB of RAM, and will cause the people surrounding you to spontaneously combust in uncontrollable jealousy. With a setup like that, you'd probably expect the battery to fizzle out in the first five minutes of gaming, but you'd be wrong. The 9-cell battery can take an hour and five minutes of continuous gaming, which, given the nature of its extreme use, is very impressive, and a goodish bit beyond what other gaming laptops would give you. Moreover, the fact that it's a laptop just makes it easier to take to a LAN party and brag.

URL: www.dell.com

No more tears

A nagging "feature" of laptops is their incredible penchant for going *pfift* after a couple of hours of continuous use—and this just with regular PC use. Try playing a game and you'd barely make it past level one! To counter this tragic occurrence, companies are in a mad race to create the next fuel-cell battery for the laptop. At

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